

Solar gardening

Australian inventors Brendan Corry and Peter Sargent have invented Wunda Weeder, a solar-powered contraption that lets gardeners take their back-breaking work lying down

Consumer protection

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Laptops

Case File #216

I can't go for HP products - poor customer after-sales service

I thank Digit magazine for offering this forum. I wish to report bad service offered to me by HP (after-sales support). I purchased a Presario cq 62-105TU two months back and was offered Norton Internet Security 2010 as part of the HP redemption scheme. I sent a draft worth `499 as demanded by HP for this package. HP instead of sending Norton Internet Security 2010, sent Norton Antivirus. The anti-virus was actually offered in another scheme at just `300 along with music/game. I was not interested in games and hence opted for Norton Internet Security 2010. I reported to HP too. HP redemption cell didn't bother to reply to my email. HP usually replies to pre-sales query within a day. But they didn't reply to my redemption issue even after a week. I've not opened the anti-virus 2010 pack sent to me by HP. Hence, I request HP to send me what has been offered to me. I can return the anti-virus to the nearest HP office once I receive Norton Internet Security 2010. I've already sent redemption details to HP via email. My redemption code is 7VDS013CCW, ref no 71010379 on the parcel, at par cheque from ICICI bank from Bhavin Ashar was sent to HP Redemption Cell. I must say HP laptop is nice with preloaded software. But I can't go for HP products in future due to its poor customer after-sales service.

Ashar Bhavesh

Answer by Consumermate:

Considering the stakes involved we can't advise you to go to the consumer court. But you must take action for the money you've spent. At this stage, you send them a letter asking them to take immediate action regarding your grievance, failing which you will be taking action in the consumer court.

Mention a claim amount in your letter. They should respond.

Case File #332

Hard Drive Problems with my Compaq CQ model

I recently bought a Compaq CQ 42-116TU notebook on May 01, 2010 and a month later, my computer doesn't restart. It doesn't detect the hard drive. I've lodged a complaint with Compaq (no 4615430329), but they say parts are unavailable.

Frankie

Answer by Consumermate:

It's a sad situation where you're facing problems with your new purchase. It is understandable that if a part is not available, the customer can be asked to wait for a reasonable time. By reasonable we definitely don't mean beyond a week's time. We'd advise you to keep a track of all the emails and communications exchanged with the company. You may write a letter to them via speed post, and call the company to rectify the problems within a week, failing which they have to pay you compensation for the loss of work and harassment caused to you.

Mobile Phones

Case File #411

Touch Screen is not working properly Boss I Phone

I had purchased a Boss I Phone Model 3300. Within a month of using it, its touch screen isn't working properly. I had already lodged a complaint at the email address given in its user manual, but haven't received any response from the company. I'm thinking of filing a case in the consumer court for this.

Arup Das

Answer by Consumermate:

It is a fit case for the consumer court. But before moving to court, you should give one final chance to the company to rectify your problems. Just make

sure all the correspondences you've had with the company are via registered mode or emails. In your letters to the company, call upon them to rectify all your problems failing which you will be restrained to take legal action. For filing the complaint, you will always have the assistance of Consumer Mate.

Case File #463

No IMEI number on Sony Ericsson W205 mobile

I had purchased a Sony Ericsson W205 mobile on July 14, 2009. Within three months, I realised that there was no IMEI number so I received a replacement; the W205 phone is giving me high trouble now. 1) The messaging application is very slow, 2) The phone software gets corrupted every two months, 3) The phone suddenly becomes non responsive, 4) the phone arbitrarily at its own wish begins to restart at its own whim and fancy, 5) phone memory decreases by 100kb a week, 6) Master resets prove worthless and these problems are really frustrating me, my phone software was reloaded on May 4th and it is already giving problems again if we try to access file manager the phone restarts the above mentioned 5 problems are also present. I request you to let me know how to try and get a replacement for my phone because it is still in warranty period now. After the warranty period, I can only imagine what i will be doing with the phone because Sony will say warranty is over so now you have to pay for the software reload.

Answer by Consumermate:

To claim replacement, you have to prove that the product was inherently defective. At this stage, you can serve a legal notice upon them asking for a change of the product and compensation for the defective product and harassment. Keep a record of all the communications and send all the letters through emails or speed post.